

Pitcher Joins Teammate As Pro Bait

Reds Draft Wally Lester

Carlsbad pitcher Wally Lester learned yesterday that he was selected by the Cincinnati Reds during last week's major league free agent draft in New York.

The 18-year-old righthander thus became the second 1972 Carlsbad Senior High School graduate to be tapped for a possible professional baseball career. Outfielder John Crider, his teammate in both high school and summer league play, was drafted at the same session by the St. Louis Cardinals.

Lester, son of Mr. and Mrs. Wallace Lester, 2608 Montana, was informed of his selection in a communication from Robert L. Howsam, executive vice president and general manager of the Reds.

Howsam said an authorized representative of the Cincinnati organization will be dispatched to Carlsbad for contract talks with Lester.

"All of us hope this first step will lead to a fine career for you in baseball as a member of the Reds' family," Howsam added.

The Cincinnati organization indicated an interest in Lester early in the 1972 high school baseball season. During a Reds' tryout camp held here recently, Lester pitched six innings of two-hit baseball, striking out 12 batters and surrendering but one run during a game pitting the local high school team against an all-star squad loaded with college talent.

He received an athletic scholarship offer at that time from University of Texas at El Paso Baseball Coach Andy Cohen and has had numerous letters and inquiries from other schools.

A master control artist, Lester also built a reputation in local baseball circles as a strikeout specialist—and a shut-out pitcher. Still, he is recognized more for his ability to keep batters continually off balance than for overpowering them.

Coincidentally, Lester pitched for the same three Carlsbad state championship clubs of which teammate Crider was a member during the past four years—the Babe Ruth

League Miners Division All-Stars of 1969, the Connie Mack American Legion team of 1971 and the Carlsbad's recently crowned 1972 state high school champion Cavemen.

He compiled an unparalleled 18-1 won-lost record in three years as a high school varsity hurler under former Caveman coach Charlie Williams and current coach Dave Perini.

Lester's senior credentials for the past high school campaign

were unmatched by any other Class AAAA prep pitcher in New Mexico: Seven complete-game shutouts among a 9-0 record, a 0.41 earned run average, just 24 hits allowed in 68 innings and 139 strikeouts against a mere 20 walks—a brilliant 7-1 ratio.

The clever righthander was a two-time All-District 4AAAA selection, a two-time all-state tournament choice and was named the district's most valuable

player—a rare honor for a pitcher—at the conclusion of his junior season.

Lester just recently embarked on his final Connie Mack season with Manager Van Nunley's American Legion Post 7 team.

In his first two starts, he (1) pitched a 3-0 no-hit win in an exhibition game and (2) struck out 20 batters in an eight-inning two-hitter that netted the Legionnaires a 1-0 victory.



KING-SIZE CAT — This giant catfish was caught near Bindle's Ranch on the Pecos River. The proud owners of this fish are from left to right, Jessie Vallejo, Simon Valenzuela, and Thomas Saldana. The weight of the catfish was estimated to be 25 to 30 pounds.

City Summer Basketball

JUNIOR DIVISION

Owls: Perry Roberts 15, Scott Melvin 15, Cass Millman 8. Sun Devils: Ronnie York 6; Mark Tatarian 1; Mark Bennett 1. Trail Blazers 43, Bulls 23.

Trail Blazers: Lonnie Barrera 22; Tommy Orgain 11; Steve Lewis 6; Bobby Burns 4. Bulls: Joe Leyva 7; Gary Lanier 4; Kevin Griffin 4; Frankie Munoz; Craig Spence 2; Ricky Martinez 2.

Knicks 56, Lakers 54.

Knicks: William Stearns 24; Tony Martinez 14; Kenny Walters 6; Frank Barrera 8; Barry Meek 2; Andrew Fisher 2.

Lakers: Raul Moreno 16; Gary Giddens 12; Ben Sanchez 12; Mike Munoz 8; Tracy Johnson 4; Albert Earnest 2. Rockets 36, Pacers 30.

Rockets: Eddie Green 22; Steve Brown 6; Adam Fierro 2; John Skinner 2; Frank Dominguez 2. Pacers: Phil Mahey 13; Terry Pierson 13; Terry Mathis 4.

Fans Tab Torre 1st

NEW YORK (AP) — Third baseman Joe Torre of the St. Louis Cardinals, who isn't tops in any National League batting category, apparently is No. 1 with National League Fans.

Torre collected 73,129 votes from fans across the country in the first day of balloting Monday for the July 25 All-Star Game in Atlanta. Ron Santo of the Chicago Cubs, his closest contender, was second with 26,227 votes.

Second in the voting was outfielder Hank Aaron of the Atlanta Braves with 69,548 votes, followed by shortstop Bud Harrelson of the New York Mets with 56,759.

The closest competition was shaping up for the catcher's position with Manny Sanguillen of Pittsburgh leading Johnny Bench of Cincinnati 48,203 to 47,305.

Following Aaron in the balloting for the three outfield spots were Roberto Clemente of Pittsburgh with 53,812 and Rusty Staub of the Mets with 50,713.

The only major upset of the first day was California Julie Kramer's victory over Donna Norman of Albuquerque 6-1, 6-1 in the girls' 14 and under bracket.

Clark, top seeded in the boys' 18 and under category faced Doug Kerr of Tucson, Ariz., next. He upset Richard Resta

Minor Leagues...

(Monday's Results)

PCL Results—Tucson 5, Albuquerque 1; Eugene 10, Tacoma 2; Salt Lake 10, Phoenix 3; Hawaii 7, Portland 6.

Texas League Results—Midland 12, Shreveport 11; Amarillo 4, Arkansas 3; San Antonio 5, Memphis 4; Alexandria 6, El Paso 1.

Pacific Coast Standings Western Division—Eugene 37-26; Tacoma 29-34-480; Hawaii 27-35-429; Portland 24-37-393.

Eastern Division—Phoenix 38-25-603; Albuquerque 35-29-547 (3 1/2 games behind); Salt Lake City 34-29-540; Tucson 28-36-438.

Albuquerque Foe First For El Paso Team